



— Academy

Commissioner Presentation Prep

LEADERSHIP

CORE

Turn the roll into decisions a commissioner can act on in five minutes.

THE PROBLEM

What you're facing

You have to brief commissioners (or a chief deputy) on the assessment cycle in minutes — people who need decisions and risk, not methodology.

WHY IT MATTERS

What's at stake

Leadership funds, defends, and explains the office. If they can't quickly grasp where the risk is and what's being done, the office loses credibility and budget, and surprises become crises.

THE MENTAL MODEL

How experts think

Experts brief the way the County Pulse reads: lead with what to watch, then what it means, then what's being done — and stop. They translate COD and ratio drift into revenue and equity consequences, and they bring three decisions, not thirty charts.

Workflow

1. Open with the 3-5 things that actually matter this cycle.
2. Translate each into revenue and equity consequences.
3. State what the office is already doing about it.
4. Surface the one or two decisions you need from leadership.
5. Leave the methodology in an appendix unless asked.

Common mistakes

- Presenting methodology instead of decisions.
- Burying the risk under data.
- Bringing thirty charts and no recommendation.
- Speaking in COD/PRD instead of dollars and fairness.

Tools

County Pulse briefing Revenue/levy impact figures Ratio + equity summary One-page decision sheet

DO THIS NEXT

Now What?

- 1 Build the briefing from "what to watch → what it means → what we're doing."
- 2 Translate every technical metric into revenue or equity terms.
- 3 Bring the two decisions you actually need — and the appendix for the rest.

Further reading: County Pulse (operational briefing surface) · IAAO on communicating assessment results

